

God Uses Your New Nature to Teach You

Jesus Teaches Spiritual Truth Through Natural Comparisons

Are you ready?

Glory. Don't you just love the way Jesus teaches? By the Holy Spirit, He always uses something we can understand with our natural mind.

He says, "Your righteousness is as filthy rags," and you say, "What is He saying?" Then you see the comparison and understand.

He said a greater than Solomon is here. He said when a man lights a candle and takes it into a dark room, it is not to be hidden under a bushel. What made Him greater than Solomon is that the same way that candle lit the dark room, your new nature has lit your spirit. That is what He gave you that was greater than Solomon.

There is always a comparison He uses to teach. The Holy Ghost taught me to write like that. That is why I use examples like a goldfish that adopts a piranha and tries to make him nice, but he keeps eating his friends. You cannot beat the new nature into something that does not have one.

He taught me to write like that. Right when your intellect and discernment are reaching to understand the revelation, that is the point where you are supposed to switch and give people something to understand it with.

Are you ready?

Hallelujah.

The Spirit We Received Gives Capacity to Know God's Free Gifts

We will pick this up where we left off, in 1 Corinthians 2:12. Because this is such new material, we are going to review briefly one more time, establishing "spiritual things to spiritual," before we take it a step further.

Follow me very, very closely.

First Corinthians 2:12 says:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

We have not received the spirit that is of this world, that unregenerated human spirit we inherited from the first man Adam. That is not the one we have now.

We received the spirit which is of God, little "s," the born-again human spirit. We did not receive the spirit from the first man Adam, the death he had. We received the new nature and life from the second man Adam, which is of God.

Why?

"That we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

Now that we have been translated out of darkness into the kingdom of light of His dear Son, we did not come into the kingdom knowing everything. We came into the kingdom of God with a capacity, through the new nature, to be taught and the ability to understand the things of God.

For this reason, He sent the third Person of the Godhead, that great Teacher, to step down in us. He has a nature like your nature. He came to teach us and guide us into all truth. John 17 says, "Thy word is truth."

In these next few verses, Paul reveals the teaching process by which the Holy Ghost comes to give you what no man can give.

The apostle leaves off apostling, the prophet leaves off prophesying, the teacher has taught, the exhorter has exhorted, the pastor has pastored, and the evangelist has evangelized. The Holy Spirit has come to give you what no man can.

He is teaching in these verses not only where Paul got his revelation from, but how the Holy Spirit transfers revelation from God to you.

Comparing Requires Something in Us Like What God Teaches

After Paul says we do not have Adam's spirit anymore, but that born-again human spirit by which we can freely understand the things given to us by God, he makes reference to those things in verse 13:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words
which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things
with spiritual."

"Which things" are the things freely given to us of God. Paul says we speak, teach, and preach them, not in words that man's wisdom teaches, but in words the Holy Ghost teaches.

Notice the difference between verses 12 and 13. In verse 12 Paul says:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God."

He is making reference to your born-again human spirit.

But when he makes reference to the Holy Spirit as your Teacher, he does not call Him "the Spirit of God" there. He calls Him the Holy Ghost, the Teacher, so you will understand he is not talking about your regenerated born-again human spirit, but literally about the third Person of the Godhead who has come to be your Teacher.

He says what we have learned has not been from the wisdom of men. The wisdom that taught us is straight from heaven, and this is who taught it:

"Which the Holy Ghost teacheth."

How does He teach?

"Comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

That word "comparing" is the key. In order to make a comparison, what I am comparing something to has to already have something resident in it, or no comparison can be made.

When you compare identical twins, one twin has what you need to compare with the other twin. If the second party has nothing to compare what the first party has with, there is no comparison.

Paul did not simply say the Holy Ghost teaches spiritual things to us. He says He teaches by comparing spiritual things with spiritual.

If these things are being taught to me by the Holy Spirit, then when I first came into the kingdom of God, I must have come into what He is comparing spiritual things with. I must have possessed it the moment I stepped out of darkness into the kingdom of His Son, or how could He have even begun the teaching process?

There must be something I already possess for Him to compare spiritual things with.

What is it that you possess? A new nature.

If you want to know how strong this is, you are not who you used to be. The old man has literally passed away, and a new man with a new nature has come into existence in his place.

You do not belong anymore to the same species. You are not a piranha anymore. You are a goldfish. You only have teeth for the devil.

Make no mistake, devil. I am wise as a serpent, but I am as harmless as a dove. The only teeth I have are for you.

The Natural Man Cannot Discern What Requires a New Nature

The moment you come into the kingdom of God as a strapping youngster, the only thing you probably possess is the new nature and the message that invoked you into salvation. That is about all you possess.

But that is enough, because now you have what God needs to begin comparing the spiritual things of God with that new-nature part of you that can finally understand the things of God.

You no longer have the spirit of this world, from the first man Adam. You have the born-again spirit from God, that you may know the things freely given to you of God.

Verse 14 switches back to the unregenerated man, that spirit you received from the first man Adam:

"But the natural man receiveth not
the things of the Spirit of God:
for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them,
because they are spiritually discerned."

That word "discerned" is much stronger than knowledge or understanding. I can understand mathematical formulas. I can understand that where no oxen are, the stall is clean. My natural mind can understand that, but I cannot discern what it means without the spirit.

Jesus is not talking here about a born-again person only looking at things through the natural mind. He is talking about the man who has not received the new nature yet. He cannot know the things of God because they are strictly spiritually discerned by the new nature.

That is why a person can be filled with the Holy Ghost, speak with tongues in short little bursts once or twice a month when provoked in church, and still live his whole lifetime with the Holy Spirit taken hostage: no power, no victory, bad attitude, defeated, with a deteriorated mouth.

He can live his whole life like that and never take advantage of that new nature and the Holy Spirit's ability in him to cause him to understand spiritual things, because he will not yield himself over to God.

The word "discerned" is much stronger than knowledge. It is stronger than understanding. It means that without this, you cannot understand. In fact, the word discern is so strong that it points to a nature change.

Baby Piranha Discerns What His Nature Already Knows

One more time, my friend, using natural examples.

When Mama Goldfish adopted Baby Piranha, she said, "Come on, little Jeffrey Dahmer. Come with me. I must teach you how to build a goldfish nest."

He can understand what she is saying. He understands how to put the sticks where they belong and everything she says, but he just does not understand the purpose for it. Nothing about it agrees with him.

Then Mama Piranha comes home and runs Mama Goldfish off, taking little Jeffrey back under her fin. Immediately Mama Piranha starts teaching him the ways of a piranha.

He says, "Now I understand. I understand."

She says, "Now that cow is going to cross the river. This is what we are going to do."

He says, "You do not have to tell me."

He instinctively knows they are going to strip every inch of that cow, like some of your friends. Only it is a lot nicer when you get a lawyer to do it for you.

What did she say?

"Of course you are innocent. You have your rights. All piranhas have rights. All goldfish have rights."

He says, "You do not have to say another word to me, Mama. I know what to do to that cow."

Next thing you know, that cow is trying to get out of the river with little Jeffrey hanging on his hind leg.

How can he know? Because he can discern it. He may not even know how he knows, but he knows because he has that nature. You do not even have to teach him that he is supposed to kill. He knows.

This is the part of you the Holy Ghost can compare spiritual things to. Now that you have the nature of God, you just know, and you can understand what God wants you to know as the Holy Spirit begins this process of comparing the spiritual things of God to your spirit through the new nature He has given you.

Tongues Is the Medium of Exchange for Revelation

"Brother Roberson, what is the medium of exchange here?"

Money is a medium of exchange. I can convert land to little pieces of gold, or now paper, put it in a little box, get it out later, and convert it back into land. It is a medium of exchange, a way to take things that are worth something, store them in this medium, and convert them back later.

You can put the labor of five hundred men in Brazil into a little envelope and send it overseas. When they open it up, that medium of exchange puts five hundred men to work for six months. That power passed through a little envelope.

Is there a medium of exchange that can guarantee spiritual things will be discerned by my human spirit? Yes.

Is it the Word of God? The Word of God is the record of some other man receiving revelation and writing it down on paper. That does not mean you can understand it. It means you have a capacity to understand it.

There are people with the new nature who have memorized the whole Word of God, and if you ask them what some of the simplest revelations mean, they will not be able to tell you.

So the Word is part of the information the Holy Spirit is handling. But there still has to be an exchange from that Word and from the Holy Spirit to your spirit, or directly from the Word to your spirit. However it gets in there, for you to have faith, it has to get in there.

Faith is a product of your spirit. The Word of God is information for that faith, but faith takes place in your spirit.

I need a guarantee of something God has done deliberately for me. Can I start out with just the new nature and a capacity to understand spiritual things? Is there a way to guarantee that I will end up discerning and understanding spiritual things, producing faith, power, fulfillment of His plan, understanding of wisdom, and the opening of every part of His Word?

Is there something I can do as a medium of exchange that guarantees the transfer from spiritual things to the spiritual understanding capacity I have in my born-again spirit?

Yes.

Paul gives the hint in verse 13:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words
which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things
with spiritual."

It is not in a language man's wisdom teaches, but in the language of wisdom the Holy Ghost teaches. Somehow, through the medium of this language, He was able to transfer revelation knowledge, spiritual insight, and wisdom to my human spirit.

What language are we talking about? It must be some kind of language that edifies a person. It must be some kind of language that builds them up beyond their own understanding, and edification in faith must affect their understanding of the Word of God.

If a person does that, He promised to build them up on their most holy faith. We know faith really only comes one way: by hearing and hearing by what God has said.

What language are we basically talking about as the medium of exchange?

Could there possibly be somebody sitting here who does not know what we are talking about?

The day you decide to spend just one hour with that supernatural language of tongues rolling out of your spirit is the day you walk into the classroom of the Holy Spirit. That fine-dressed gentleman at the chalkboard is none other than the Holy Spirit Himself.

Like any professor and student relationship, you do not automatically know what your professor knows. His knowledge must be transferred to you.

That is the day you walk into the classroom of the Holy Spirit and are about to know that the fine-dressed Gentleman at the chalkboard, who is none other than the Holy Spirit, is about to teach you what He knows.

We are only thirty minutes in. What shall I mark off my list? It just gets too good.

Hidden Wisdom Is Carried in the Spirit's Language

My life, success or failure, is not up to you. It is up to me.

If this medium of exchange is the supernatural language of the Holy Spirit, then He can package all that wisdom, understanding, and glory of God into that language, send it overseas to my spirit, and lay it out. That medium of exchange, that supernatural language, must contain something.

The things we are understanding are the wisdom that was hidden in a mystery.

Back up to 1 Corinthians 2:6:

"Howbeit we speak wisdom
among them that are perfect:
yet not the wisdom of this world,
nor of the princes of this world,
that come to nought:
but we speak the wisdom of God
in a mystery,
even the hidden wisdom,
which God ordained before the world
unto our glory:
which none of the princes of this world knew:
for had they known it,
they would not have crucified
the Lord of glory."

Then Paul says:

"But as it is written,
Eye hath not seen,
nor ear heard,
neither have entered into the heart of man,
the things which God hath prepared
for them that love him."

The heart he was talking about there was the spiritually unregenerated heart with the old nature, which they had under the Old Covenant. It was impossible for the understanding of this mystery, which Paul was now teaching to those with a new nature, to enter into those who had an old nature.

If the princes of this world, those kingdoms that came and went, had understood what was in this mystery, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory. But they did not understand it because it was hidden in a mystery.

Paul is saying, "We speak the wisdom of God in a mystery." He does not mean they were standing there teaching wisdom in a mystery that you cannot understand because it is mysterious. He means this wisdom was once hidden in a mystery that could not be understood because of spiritual death.

But now that the Church has been born again, the wisdom that was once hidden has been made available, and He sent the Holy Ghost to teach it to you.

That is why Paul can say:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words
which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things
with spiritual."

Paul Prayed in Tongues More Because He Needed the Mysteries

This is why Paul said in 1 Corinthians 14:

"I thank my God,
I speak with tongues more than ye all."

Haven't you caught on yet? Don't you understand what I am trying to say to you?

Paul was responsible for salvaging the Church and sliding her foundation back under her against Judaism and pagan worship. Where did he get his knowledge? At the age of three, he was memorizing the Word of God. He was a Pharisee of Pharisees. Concerning zeal, he persecuted this new doctrine that sprung up against the faith of the fathers, hauling Christians into a kangaroo court and putting them to death.

That is why he said, "I am not meet to be called one of His apostles."

But one thing God let him do: he became an example of suffering, to show the lengths he would go in the hands of men to make sure everybody heard this gospel.

He said, in effect, "I thank my God that I had that zeal with the faith of my fathers, and I have the same zeal in the presence of the Lord Jesus Christ. I thank my God that I pray more in the supernatural language that encompasses the understanding of the mysteries of Christ than any man."

He proved it when he withstood Peter face to face.

Certain men came from James, Judaizers, born-again Jews zealous of the law. Peter was caught in dissimulation. Before they came, he would eat with the Gentiles. After those came from James, the Jews immediately separated themselves, Peter included.

Paul said, "Before they came, Peter, you would eat with them."

He was not talking about our faith banquets where we raise money. You think the meal is free? Wait until you get there. He was talking about Peter eating food that was not kosher. Before they came, he would lay into a hog leg. After they came, he would not eat the same things the Gentiles did.

So Paul confronted him face to face in front of them all:

"If you, by nature, were a Jew and not a sinner like these Gentiles, and if you were saved by the law, then left the law and went to live after the manner of the Gentiles, why do you now compel the Gentiles to live after the manner of the Jews? If the law could have saved you, why did you leave it in the first place?"

Paul said:

"I do not frustrate the grace of God:
for if righteousness come by the law,
then Christ is dead in vain."

Paul was hell on wheels. He was something to contend with.

So when he said, "I thank my God that I pray more in the supernatural language that encompasses the understanding of the mysteries of Christ than all of you," take the hint.

Personal Tongues Speaks to God and Edifies the Believer

Would you like a little bit of truth? Then you would like to go to 1 Corinthians 14.

Verse 1 says:

"Follow after charity,
and desire spiritual gifts,
but rather that ye may prophesy."

Follow after love in action and desire spiritual gifts. No problem there. But Paul says, "rather that ye may prophesy," because he was talking about excelling to a place in the Corinthian church where the giftings they received were good for the edification of other people.

In teaching them to excel to a place where they edified others, he had to differentiate between tongues for interpretation, the simple gift of prophecy, and tongues for personal edification.

Tongues with interpretation edifies the whole body. The gift of prophecy edifies the whole body. But praying in tongues edifies yourself. He had to differentiate between the two.

He was not glorifying one gift above another, such as prophecy above tongues, workings of miracles, or gifts of healings. He was teaching them to excel to a place where the gifts would edify others. To do that, they needed to take advantage of this first simple gift until they were edified to where they could edify the body through the giftings that would come through it.

He was not saying, "Forget praying in tongues and go for prophecy." He was saying one was the result of the other.

Verse 2 says:

"For he that speaketh
in an unknown tongue
speaketh not unto men,
but unto God:
for no man understandeth him;
howbeit in the spirit
he speaketh mysteries."

Who am I talking to? God.

Am I talking to you? No. I am talking to God. So if I am talking to God, leave me alone. Why would you interrupt a conversation with Him?

Yet when we had all-day prayer Saturday, that happened a lot.

So much for warring tongues. Who are you warring with, God?

It is not the forcefulness and authority of your vocal cords added to that language as it passes through you that makes the difference. He needed one thing from you. He created this language in your human spirit because He had to borrow your authority.

In actuality, verse 14 says it is you who is praying:

"For if I pray in an unknown tongue,
my spirit prayeth."

He had to borrow your authority. This language had to come from you, but the thoughts, paragraphs, and chapters come from Him. They contain the mysteries, and they carry the plan of God for your personal life.

This whole language is being communicated back up to your Father as the Holy Ghost creates it in your spirit.

Listen closely. It is not how much authority you add through your emotions as this language passes through your mouth that does good. He already got the authority He needed with your consent to pray. That is all He needed: for you to let Him pass it through you. You do not have to add anything to it.

"I am going to pray real strong and hard."

Go ahead. You are still going to say the same thing.

Whenever the warring tongues people came to spend a day with us in prayer, their war would last about two hours. Then they realized they had six more to go. Pretty soon they just laid down like the rest of us. In fact, they were barely using their vocal cords.

Does it matter? You are getting the same results. It is not what you add to it. He has already added that. Now it is what He is saying. It is the mind of Christ being transferred to your mind, the spiritual mind. It is what He is saying, and He is the One authorized to be answered.

The Carrot Gift Makes You Steward of Your Own Edification

Verse 2 says:

"For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue
speaketh not unto men,
but unto God:
for no man understandeth him."

Why does no man understand him? Because Paul is not talking about tongues for interpretation. That diversity of tongue the body will understand because somebody gets up and makes them understand it. The gift of prophecy you understand automatically the moment it comes out of your lips.

But this one no man understands, because you are not talking to any man. This one is for your own personal edification.

This is the most unusual gift. It is kind of like carrots. You do not see carrots used in everything. You do not usually have carrots on your hamburgers. Once in a while, you find them in steamed vegetables because they give it a little color.

Among vegetables, carrots are like praying in tongues. Since tongues is considered the least of the nine gifts, praying in tongues is the carrot of the vegetable world. But if you want to get real healthy, juice a lot of them and drink about half a gallon a day.

Of all the things that have what your body needs and are most compatible, it is that lowly little gift of tongues, that carrot juice. Grind it up and drink it, and you are in business. You get to feeling so good that not only can we not stand you, you cannot stand yourself.

All the other giftings flow from God through you for the edification of others. Word of wisdom, word of knowledge, workings of miracles, gifts of healings, discerning of spirits, most of those in a public setting flow through you for others.

There are four diversities of tongues: tongues for personal edification, tongues for interpretation in the public assembly, tongues for the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit, and tongues as a sign to the unbeliever.

Out of those four, there is only one that flows to you instead of through you, for your own edification. Because of that, God has made you the steward of its operation. You are the captain of your own ship. You set your own destiny. You order your own path.

He has made you the steward of how edified you want to be. Through the Holy Spirit-supplied prayer, you order God into your life in the purest vein possible.

This simple gift, the carrot, flows to me. Because it flows to me, He has made me the steward of its operation, and therefore the steward of just how edified I want to be, how big a bite of God I want to take, and how closely I want to find His plan and walk in it.

Mysteries Are Spoken in the Human Spirit by the Holy Ghost

If I pray in an unknown tongue, I am speaking not to men but to God. No man understands me because this is not the tongue to be interpreted in a public assembly.

Paul finishes verse 2:

"Howbeit in the spirit
he speaketh mysteries."

"Howbeit" is an analytical word. If a man around you does not understand it, and even you yourself are not understanding it, and God is the only One who understands, then please, Apostle Paul, straighten out the confusion. What good is the tongue? You say it edifies us, but we do not understand it and people around us do not. How does it edify?

In a couple of words, Paul straightens out everything he introduced in the second chapter:

"In the spirit he speaketh mysteries."

He puts a little "s" there because it is the human spirit that is being referred to. Verse 14 says:

"For if I pray in an unknown tongue,
my spirit prayeth."

My human spirit prays this prayer as it is being created within me by the Holy Spirit.

When the Holy Ghost compares spiritual things with spiritual, what is the medium? The supernatural language.

Why? Because Paul said this wisdom was hidden in a mystery, but a group of apostles who were born again went in and got it out. He said, "Which things we teach you now, not in the language man's wisdom taught us, but in the language the Holy Ghost taught us, comparing spiritual with spiritual."

How did the Holy Ghost get the wisdom that was in God into Paul?

Here in chapter 14 Paul says:

"Howbeit in the spirit
he speaketh mysteries."

This man is doing the praying. God is no respecter of persons.

In this man's human spirit, he is speaking mysteries. Which mysteries? The ones that were hidden in God on the other side of spiritual death before the foundation of the world, but are now made available to you and me, who can understand them through the new nature.

Now the Holy Ghost has come to guide you into all truth.

How were we so ignorant that we could not see that the simple gift of praying in tongues is a revelation gift? It ensures you the wisdom and understanding of the mystery of Christ in you, to you and through you, the hope of glory.

When men leave off, He comes to compare spiritual to spiritual. He has come with a commission. He is not a man that He can lie. He has come to guide you into all truth. He is so single-minded and focused on His mission that He will not even speak of Himself. He is commissioned only to glorify Jesus and reveal Him in you: the mystery of Christ in you, your hope of glory.

Carnality Follows Men Instead of the God Who Gives Increase

Go back to 1 Corinthians 2:14:

"But the natural man receiveth not
the things of the Spirit of God:
for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them,
because they are spiritually discerned."

The natural man cannot receive these things of the Spirit of God. They are foolishness to him. He cannot even know them because they are spiritually understood.

Verse 15 says:

"But he that is spiritual
judgeth all things,
yet he himself is judged of no man."

Why? Because he was not taught by the wisdom of men, but in the language the Holy Ghost taught, whether through the apostles or through the Holy Spirit Himself.

Verse 16 says:

"For who hath known the mind of the Lord,
that he may instruct him?
But we have the mind of Christ."

My born-again spirit has a mind that can understand revelation knowledge.

Then Paul goes on in chapter 3:

"And I, brethren,
could not speak unto you as unto spiritual,
but as unto carnal,
even as unto babes in Christ.
I have fed you with milk,
and not with meat:
for hitherto ye were not able to bear it,
neither yet now are ye able.
For ye are yet carnal:
for whereas there is among you envying,
and strife,
and divisions,
are ye not carnal,
and walk as men?"

In God's standard, this whole book of 1 Corinthians is a book of milk to babies. If you cannot understand it, you have some growing to do.

What qualifies me to be carnal? Envy, strife, and divisions. Are you not carnal and walking as mere men, as men who have not been regenerated yet?

You stop somebody outside the church and tell them off because that is your parking place. I am mad at you, and you are mad at me.

Hello, milky.

Then Paul says:

"For while one saith,
I am of Paul;
and another,
I am of Apollos;
are ye not carnal?"

He picked some pretty good role models. In the true light of things, understand what he says:

"Who then is Paul,
and who is Apollos,
but ministers by whom ye believed,
even as the Lord gave to every man?
I have planted,
Apollos watered;
but God gave the increase."

Paul gave you a foundation. Apollos came and helped teach you. Each ministered according to the gifting the Lord gave. Paul planted you. Apollos watered your spirit.

But who gives the increase? It is not man.

Who are you to be so carnal that you say you are following anybody but God? These are the servants who gave you the information, got you saved, and watered you.

Who increases you? I cannot do that.

Paul says:

"So then neither is he that planteth any thing,
neither he that watereth;
but God that giveth the increase."

Thank you very much. Have I been hurt or insulted?

No. I am just fulfilling my call. I am part of this thing. The increase only comes from God.

Quit feeding your body, and it will die. Quit feeding your spirit, and it will not die, because it is self-existing and eternal. But it will quit growing.

You can enter heaven the same way you were the day you were born again. That is what usually happens when you follow men and they give you no increase.

Are you carnal or what?

Of course you are not. You are here.

Glory be to God forever.